Read before you write: PRIMM and tracing

Programming · Level 3 · Lesson 1



Today we will

- Plan a PRIMM lesson.
- Trace a program in a trace table.
- Write predict questions that reveal misconceptions.

Remember

- Predict, Run, Investigate, Modify, Make.
- A wrong prediction is a misconception made visible.
- Trace on paper first, then check.

Predict, run, investigate

1. Predict (5 min): Pairs predict what a loop program prints.
2. Run (5 min): Run it on one phone; compare.
3. Trace (10 min): Fill in a trace table, row by row.
4. Modify (15 min): Change the program to do something new.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Which prediction was most common? Exit ticket.

Only the Run stage needs a device, and one phone is enough. Everything else works on paper.

Let’s discuss

1. Why does predicting help pupils more than running straight away?
2. Which misconception did the predictions show?
3. How could you use trace tables without any devices?

Exit ticket

- Write a predict question for a three-line program, with one wrong answer and the misconception it shows.